

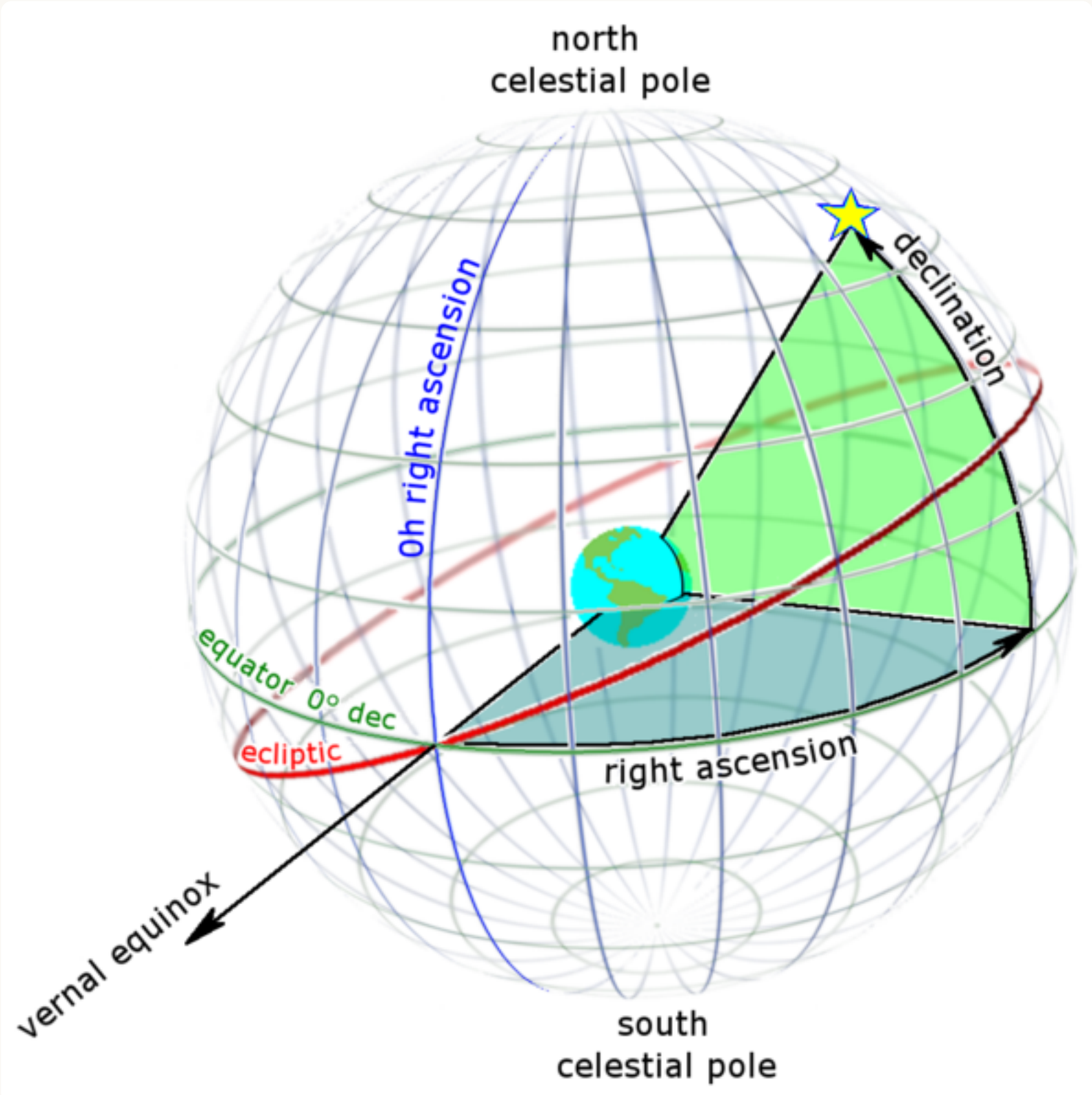
Declinations

The position of a planet or other point can be expressed in several ways. In your horoscope chart you see the longitude, which is the position along the ecliptic. Planets are usually not exactly on the ecliptic but slightly above or below it. This deviation is called latitude. Besides longitude, a planet can also be expressed in right ascension, the position along the celestial equator. Here too there can be a deviation, and this is called declination.

Right ascension is not used directly in astrology but only as an auxiliary tool for calculations. Declination, however, has always been an important element in interpretation. Well known are the parallel aspects, the role of declinations in archaeo-astronomy, and the interpretive system of Kt Boehrer.



Astronomical Background



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In the figure the equator is shown in green. The position measured along the equator from the point 0 degrees Aries is the right ascension. The declination of the indicated star is determined by measuring the distance from the equator to that star along a circle perpendicular to the equator (the hour circle).



Parallels and Counter-Parallels

When one factor has approximately the same declination as another factor, we speak of a *parallel*. When the declination values are equal but one factor has northern declination and the other southern declination, we speak of a *counter-parallel*.

In interpretation, astrologers often treat a parallel as a (weak) conjunction and a counter-parallel as a (weak) opposition. Paul Newman, among others, offers a different perspective on this.



Longitude Equivalents

Except for the Sun, lunar node, and house cusps, all factors have a latitude, a deviation from the ecliptic.

A longitude equivalent is the point on the ecliptic that a factor would occupy if it had no latitude but the same declination. Especially for planets with a significant latitude, this can make a considerable difference.

In this way a new horoscope can be constructed.



OOB – Out of Bounds Positions

A factor is OOB (Out of Bounds) when its declination exceeds the maximum declination of the Sun, which is slightly less than 23.5 degrees. This can only happen to factors that have latitude, so not to the Sun itself, nor to the Lunar Node or house cusps.

When a factor is OOB it operates, according to Kt Boehrer, 'outside normal conditions or expectations'.



Midpoints in Declination

Reinhold Ebertin introduced midpoints in declination in the 1970s. The principle is the same as for the usual midpoints in longitude. Because declinations generally fall within a range of approximately 50°, the chance of hits is greater. A smaller orb is therefore advisable.



Bibliography

1. Kt Boehrer – *Declination: The Other Dimension*, 1994.
2. Reinhold Ebertin – *Deklinationen-Parallelen im Geburtsbild*, 1979.
3. Paul F. Newman – *Declination in Astrology: The Steps of the Sun*, 2006.